(i) Find the day with minimum number of absentees?

(ii) Mention the day with ten absentees.

(iii) Which day of the week has no absentees ?

(iv) Find the day on which maximum number of children were absent?

5.2 Collection of data

We need to collect data having the specific information in our mind. Suppose the specific information needed by us is to know the height of class VII students, then we should collect specific data related to their heights and ages rather than the data related to health record of students.

From the above discussion, we conclude that the purpose for which a data is to be collected has to be kept in mind before starting the process of data collection. Then only we can get the desired information, which is appropriate to the purpose. Let us look into a few situations that are given below.

Data can be generated in many situations around us. For example,

- The height of class VII students.
- The performance of class VII students in the term II examinations.
- The number of trees planted in your locality.
- The highest temperatures recorded in all the major cities of India during the year 2018.
- The least amount of rainfall recorded in all the districts of Tamil Nadu during the year 2018.

5.3 Organisation of Data

We first collect data, record it and organise them. To understand this, consider an example which deals with the weights of 10 students of class VII. These are collected to know whether the weights of students are appropriate to their heights. The data is given below.

- Anbu-20 *kg*; Nambi-19 *kg*; Nanthitha- 20 *kg*; Arul- 24 *kg*;
- Mari-25 *kg*; Mathu-22 *kg*; Pavithra – 23 *kg*; Beeman- 26 *kg*;
- Arthi-21 *kg*; Kumanan-25 *kg*.

Let us try to answer the following questions.

(i) Who is the least weight of all?

(ii) How many students weigh between 22 *kg* to 24 *kg*?

(iii) Who is the heaviest of all?

(iv) How many children are above 23 *kg* and how many are below 23 *kg*?

The data mentioned above is not easy to understand.

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